Aluta — Harmony ("Our Space") Product Plan

A music-native roadmap for the couple/bond experience

Prepared for: Anesius · **Version:** 1.5 · **Date:** 3 October 2026 (updated 4 October 2026) · **Status:** Phase 1 shipped · Keepsake live (durable media + video/GIF) · moments react + comment, caption-over-media, a two-way bridge into Our Diary, and one unified moment composer (media + dedications)

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0. Shipped since v1.0

Progress against this plan, so the doc stays honest:

- **Phase 1 — The heartbeat: shipped.** Soundtrack of Us (as "Our Playlist", upgraded with per-track memo / source / annotation — §5.1), the Daily "Us" question with its music variant (§5.2), and Dedications incl. voice note + the "reminds me of you" / listen-together feeds (§5.3) are all built end-to-end (models, API, Flutter UI, WS events).
- **Keepsake — new bridge (not in v1.0): live.** A chat bubble can be "kept" into Our Space as a private moment from *any* conversation. Full spec in **§5.10**.
- **Durable, self-contained moments (v1.2).** Kept — and *forwarded* — media no longer merely references the transient chat attachment (which the store-and-forward purge reaps, and which the partner isn't authorised for). It now captures a **durable copy from the device's local cache** at keep/forward time and re-uploads it as a non-ephemeral, moment-owned asset; the backend authorises both bond members to view it. New design principle **§2.8**.
- **Keepsake now covers video and GIF (v1.2).** Moment kinds added: `video` (inline-playable in the card, full-screen player) and `gif` (labelled "A GIF", still animated) — so the moments wall shows the *honest* media type, never flattening everything to "A photo".
- **Keepsake UI matured (v1.2).** The bubble quick-action is now a **subtle, ambient "star"** (a faint themed sparkle on a near-transparent circle) that shows only on real media bubbles (photo/video/voice/song — not text/GIF/sticker), rests hidden, eases in on a tap (gentle grow + 400 ms dissolve) and fades out on scroll/idle, and is **pinned** inside the full-screen photo/video viewers. The keep composer gained emoji input, tap-to-add warmth chips, and a destination + privacy line.
- **Moments react + comment, like the diary (v1.3).** A kept moment on the wall is no longer a single two-way ❤. It now carries the **same multi-emoji reactions and threaded comments** the shared diary already has — both partners can react with any emoji (toggle on/off, counts shown) and leave, edit or delete comments, with the author badge and avatars reused from the diary. A new `space_moment_comment` WebSocket nudge live-refreshes the open wall, alongside the existing `space_moment` reaction/keep nudge.
- **Fewer, calmer surfaces (v1.5).** Two more sections folded away to reduce redundancy: **Song & milestones** is gone as its own section — its "your song" + days/streak + next-milestone card now sits (opaque) at the top of **Our Playlist**, where the hero already echoes the song. On the dashboard, the quick **"Thinking of you"** nudge moved to sit right under the hero (above every card) as the first action in reach, and the Our Playlist action buttons + the Plans-ahead chip were made opaque so the wallpaper never washes controls out.

- **One unified moment composer + Dedications merged in (v1.5).** "Send a moment" is no longer song-only — it now pins a **photo, video, voice note, file, song, or note**, picking from the device and uploading a durable copy on pin (size-capped: 64 MB video, 15 MB else; File auto-routes by type to photo/gif/video/voice). The separate **Dedications** section is gone: dedications now interleave with moments in **one time-sorted Pinned moments feed**, and the full dedication flow (song + mood + optional voice note, delivered as an event) lives inside the same composer via a "Dedicate a song instead" action. The dedication data model, cards and open/opened flow are unchanged — just surfaced in one place.
- **Pinned-moment card, romanced + a bridge into Our Diary (v1.4).** The card is tighter and cleaner: a **solid, opaque** surface (the accent gradient wash was dropped — it let the wallpaper bleed through and dissolved the action buttons), a slightly smaller media cap (so reactions + comments never get cut off), and — for media moments — the **caption now floats bold and centred over the bottom of the photo/video** on a gentle scrim (with a tiny heart), instead of sitting as plain text beneath. Each moment also gains a **"Write about this in Our Diary"** gateway: it opens the diary composer seeded with the moment's caption and a "from a pinned moment" banner, and the saved memory **carries the moment's thumbnail at the top of its diary page, tappable to glide straight back to that moment on the wall** (which briefly glows). Our Diary's `DiaryEntry` gained `source_moment_id` + `source_thumb` for this link; the thumb reuses the moment's own asset (already authorised to both partners), so no new access clause was needed.
- **Video capability added to chat (v1.2).** The app now **picks, compresses (on-device, mobile), sends, and plays** video in DMs/groups — the prerequisite for video keepsakes. See **§6**.
- **Open decision #2 (one partner vs. many bonds): resolved.** Harmony is **not** strictly 1:1 — a user may hold several bonded spaces (partner, a sibling, a close relative). Keepsake and the Dedicate / Add-to-Playlist bubble actions present a destination picker when the user has more than one bond.

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1. Executive summary

Harmony (the couple / "Our Space" surface) should not try to out-feature the generic couple apps (Paired, Cupla, Between, Lovewick). They already own streaks, daily questions and shared calendars. **Aluta's unfair advantage is music plus real-time presence** — a combination none of them can copy. The plan therefore bends every borrowed idea toward that core: the relationship is expressed *through* music and shared listening, and the generic rituals are built *around* that centre rather than beside it.

The guiding philosophy — taken straight from the research and worth protecting — is: **reward the relationship, not app-opening.** Couples come back because *something between the two of them* is waiting, not because the app exploits endless scrolling or variable-reward notifications.

This document turns the idea list into an actionable plan: what already exists, the nine features worth building, a detailed spec for each (UX, data model, realtime events, effort), a three-phase roadmap, success metrics that measure relationship health rather than vanity, and the open decisions to settle before coding.

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2. Design principles (the guardrails)

1. **Reward the relationship, not the app.** Streaks and progress track *meaningful acts between partners* (answering the question, listening together, writing in the diary, sending a dedication) — never app opens or time-in-app.
2. **No "love score."** Progress is expressed as warm stages ("Growing", "Deeply connected") and memories unlocked — never a number that claims to measure a relationship.
3. **Private by default, both opt-in.** Every shared surface requires both partners; nothing broadcasts without consent. Reuse the per-friend audience gate already built for "listening now".
4. **One gentle nudge per ritual.** A dedication, a daily question — a single, meaningful notification. Never engagement bait or streak-panic spam.
5. **Long-distance is a first-class case.** Scheduled synchronized listens, presence, and capsules are designed so distance feels smaller, not larger.
6. **Music is the medium.** When a feature *can* be expressed through a song, it should be. That is the moat.
7. **Keep the space about the two of them.** Content that crosses *into* Our Space from elsewhere carries no provenance — no "from a chat" tag, no third-party identity, not even the original chat caption. Only the content and whatever warmth the keeper adds travels across, so a kept moment never pulls an outside person into the couple's private room.
8. **Durable & self-contained (v1.2).** A moment must outlive the message it came from. The everyday chat is *store-and-forward* — the server keeps almost nothing (bytes are reaped after delivery/TTL, and attachments are access-scoped to that chat's parties). So anything promoted *into* Our Space (a kept photo/video/voice/song) captures its **own durable copy** at keep time (from the device's local cache, re-uploaded non-ephemeral) and is authorised to both bond members. A treasured moment never 404s because a chat was purged or the partner wasn't in it. The same rule hardens *forwarding* between chats and Dedicate / Add-to-Playlist.

3. Current state — what Aluta already has

Harmony already ships several of the researched ideas, so these are **not** to be rebuilt:

Researched idea	Status in Aluta
#1 "In tune" streak	Not yet (Phase 3)
#2 Daily "Us" question (+ music variant)	**Shipped** (§5.2)
#3 Shared memory garden	**Shipped** — shared diary + the curated **moments wall** ("Our Space" timeline), now also fed by **Keepsake** (§5.10), which renders photo / video / voice / song / GIF / note with honest type labels and auto-fit
#5 Mood Sync	Planned (Phase 2) as a **mood variant of the Daily question** (§5.2), not a standalone section
Soundtrack of Us / "Our Playlist"	**Shipped** (§5.1)
Dedications	**Shipped** (§5.3); as of v1.5 composed from, and shown inside, the unified Pinned moments feed — no separate section
#8 Presence	Yes — "listening now" presence with per-friend privacy audience
#9 Couple music room	Largely — "listen together" (synced playback), send a song, "reminds me of you"
Bonds / private circles	Yes (1:1 **and** multiple bonds per user)
Stories / status	Yes
Chat media	Text, photo, **video (new)**, voice note, song, GIF/sticker, file, location, contact

Implication: Phase 1's ritual loop is in place. The highest-leverage *remaining* work is Phase 2/3 — Mood Sync (#5), Love Capsule (§5.5), richer listen-together (§5.6), the streak (#1), the monthly recap (#10) — plus the **"Our World" hub** (§5.9) that ties it together.

4. The vision — "Our World"

Entering Harmony should not feel like a social feed. It should feel like walking into a private room the two of them share. One hub screen, music-first:

```
                OUR WORLD
                   ❤
             284 days together


  ┌──────────────────────────────┐
  │  Today's question            │
  │  "What song are you feeling   │
  │   about us today?"           │
  └──────────────────────────────┘


  ♪  Listening together · now
  ★  Soundtrack of Us        (42 songs)
  ✎  Our diary & memories
  ✉  Love capsule            (1 waiting)
  ☾  Tonight's moment
```

The **now-listening presence is the hero**, because that is what only Aluta can do. Everything else hangs off it.

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5. Feature catalogue

Each feature below lists: **what it is**, **why it matters**, the **UX flow**, a **data model** sketch, the **realtime/backend** needed, **edge cases**, and a rough **effort** (S / M / L).

5.1 Soundtrack of Us ⭐ (centerpiece) — shipped as "Our Playlist"

What. A single living playlist owned by the couple that auto-grows from the songs that already pass between them.

Why. This is the memory garden — but through music, which is far stickier for a music app. It becomes the artefact that is *waiting* for them and the reason to return.

Sources that add a track (automatically or with one tap):

- A song shared with "reminds me of you".
- A song played during a listen-together session (offered, not forced).
- The two picks from a music daily-question (§5.4).
- Manual "add to Soundtrack" from any now-playing screen.
- **A song shared in any chat** — via the bubble's *Add to Our Playlist* action (source `share`; captures a durable copy per §2.8); see §5.10.

Each entry can carry: a one-line memory ("playing the night we…"), who added it, and the date.

UX. A dedicated tab in the hub: album-style grid / list, newest first, each row playable and long-press-to-annotate. A gentle empty state ("Your first song together starts the soundtrack").

Data model.

```
couple_soundtrack(
  id, couple_id, track_ref (song id / url / metadata),
  added_by_user_id, source ENUM(share|listen_together|question|manual),
  memo TEXT NULL, created_at )
```

`couple_id` = a stable key for the bond (sorted pair of user ids, or the existing bond id). *Shipped as* `playlist_tracks` *keyed by* `pair_key`*, with* `source` + `memo` *columns.*

Backend / realtime. REST add/list/remove; a WS `soundtrack_added` event so the partner's hub updates live. Reuse existing song-metadata plumbing.

Edge cases. De-dupe same track; allow remove (either partner); respect privacy (couple-private only).

Effort: M. Builds directly on existing song-share + diary storage.

5.2 Daily "Us" question (with music + mood variants) — shipped

What. One prompt per day shown to both; each answers privately; answers reveal **simultaneously**.

Why. The cheapest, highest-retention ritual in the whole category — and it feeds the centerpiece.

Three prompt types, mixed:

- *Text:* "What made you smile today?" · "What do you miss about me right now?"
- *Music:* "Pick a song for how you feel about us today." → both picks drop into **Soundtrack of Us**.
- *Mood (v1.5 — formerly §5.4 "Mood Sync"):* "How are we feeling?" — each picks a mood (emoji + label) blind; on the simultaneous reveal, a **mismatch** surfaces a one-tap remedy (*Play this together* — a comfort song · *Start a listen-together* · *Send a voice note / dedication*). Folding the mood check-in in here keeps it to ONE daily ritual instead of two competing cards (see §5.4 and §2.4).

UX. A card on the hub. After you answer, it shows "Waiting for …". When both have answered, both get a single gentle nudge and the card flips to reveal both answers side by side. A small archive of past questions.

Data model.

```
daily_prompt(id, date, kind ENUM(text|music|mood), body)
prompt_answer(id, prompt_id, couple_id, user_id,
              answer_text NULL, track_ref NULL, mood TEXT NULL,
              created_at, revealed BOOL)
```

Backend / realtime. A prompt-of-the-day source (curated list, rotated). WS `prompt_answered` → when both present, emit `prompt_revealed` to both (same simultaneous-reveal pattern reused by Mood Sync).

Edge cases. Time-zone fairness for "today"; one answer per partner per day; grace if only one answers (reveal next day or on nudge).

Effort: M.

5.3 Dedications — a song as a feeling — shipped

What. An upgrade to "send a song": attach a **mood** and a short **voice note**, delivered as an *event*.

Why. Turns a silent share into a moment. "You have a dedication" → opening it plays the song with your note.

UX. From any now-playing / song row: *Dedicate* → pick partner (in a bond), optional mood chip, optional ≤15s voice note, optional line. Partner receives a distinct inbox item + one nudge; opening plays song + note; it auto-adds to Soundtrack of Us with the memo. **Also reachable from a song bubble in any chat** (optional one-line note → dedicate; captures a durable copy per §2.8); see §5.10.

Data model.

```
dedication(id, couple_id, from_user_id, track_ref,
           mood TEXT NULL, voice_note_url NULL, note TEXT NULL,
           created_at, opened_at NULL)
```

Backend / realtime. Reuse voice-note recording/upload already in chat; WS `dedication_received`.

Effort: S–M (mostly a richer wrapper over existing song-share + voice notes). *(v1.5: no longer a standalone section — created from the unified moment composer's "Dedicate" action and read inline in the Pinned moments feed.)*

5.4 Mood Sync → a musical remedy

> **Decision (v1.5): not a standalone section.** Mood Sync is a near-twin of the Daily "Us" question (§5.2) — both are once-a-day, blind, simultaneous-reveal rituals (the reveal engine is literally shared). Shipping it as a second daily card would put two competing check-ins on the hub and breach the "one gentle nudge per ritual" guardrail (§2.4). It is therefore folded into **§5.2 as a rotating mood variant** (same reveal engine, one ritual, no new daily card) and does **not** take a feature tile. The spec below is retained as that variant's detail; `mood_entry` collapses into `prompt_answer.mood`.

What. Both pick a current mood **blind**; then reveal. On a mismatch, the app offers an *action*, not just an observation.

Why. Converts an emotional insight into a shared moment instead of leaving it hanging.

UX. A hub tile "How are we feeling?" → pick a mood (emoji + label). When both have set today's mood → reveal: *You ❤ feeling loved · Partner ☹ missing you.* Then a contextual suggestion: **Play this together** (a comfort song), **Start a listen-together**, or **Send a voice note / dedication**.

Data model.

```
mood_entry(id, couple_id, user_id, date, mood, created_at, revealed BOOL)
```

Backend / realtime. Same simultaneous-reveal pattern as the daily question. Suggestion logic is a simple local rule table (mismatch → remedy).

Effort: S–M (shares the reveal mechanism with §5.2).

5.5 Love Capsule / scheduled synchronized listen

What. Schedule a song + message to **unlock at a chosen time**. The long-distance power move: a *synchronized* scheduled listen — "let's both press play at 9 PM," the app counts you both in.

Why. Novel, deeply emotional, and uniquely suited to distance. Nobody in the category pairs a time capsule with synchronized playback.

UX. *Create capsule* → pick song (+ optional message / photo), pick unlock time ("Friday 8 PM"). Locked card shows a countdown on both hubs. At unlock: both get a nudge; a "press play together" screen counts down 3-2-1 and starts synchronized playback (reuse listen-together), with live reactions (§5.6).

Data model.

```
love_capsule(id, couple_id, created_by, track_ref,
             message NULL, media_url NULL,
             unlock_at, mode ENUM(message|sync_listen),
             opened_at NULL)
```

Backend / realtime. A scheduled unlock (server timer / cron) emitting `capsule_unlocked`; sync listen reuses the existing listen-together session.

Edge cases. Both-offline at unlock (hold until next open); cancel/edit before unlock; time-zone display.

Effort: M–L (scheduling + sync choreography).

5.6 Listen-together, richer

What. Three additions to the existing synced playback.

- **Live reactions.** Tap to float a heart / emoji that both see in real time on the now-playing screen — an ephemeral "concert lighter," the feeling of being there together.
- **Save this session.** After a session, offer to save it (the songs + any reactions/messages) as a dated memory on the timeline and into Soundtrack of Us.
- **Shared queue.** Both add to a queue for a planned "listening date."

Why. Deepens the one feature that is already Aluta's strongest differentiator.

Data model. `listen_session(id, couple_id, started_at, ended_at)` + `listen_reaction(session_id, user_id, emoji, at_ms)`; `listen_queue_item(session_id, track_ref, added_by, position)`.

Backend / realtime. WS `listen_reaction` broadcast within the session; session summary persisted on end.

Effort: M.

5.7 "In tune" streak — tied to the player disc styles

What. A streak that counts **meaningful acts** (answered the question, listened together, wrote in the diary, sent a dedication) on a given day — never opens.

Why. Encourages the rituals without becoming manipulative, and — crucially — its rewards cross back into the music product.

Rewards (unlocks, not scores). Milestones unlock couple cosmetics: a shared theme and an exclusive **player disc style / "anniversary vinyl" skin** (reuses the disc-style controller already built). Stages are warm labels: *New → Connected → Growing → Deeply connected → In tune.*

Data model.

```
couple_streak(couple_id, current_days, longest_days, last_active_date)
streak_event(couple_id, date, kind)        -- dedupe per day
couple_unlock(couple_id, kind, unlocked_at) -- theme / disc skin
```

Backend / realtime. Nightly roll-up; unlock hooks into the existing `PlayerStyleController` so a new "anniversary vinyl" appears in the style picker.

Edge cases. A missed day cools (don't punish harshly — e.g., freeze, or a 1-day grace). Never a guilt nudge.

Effort: M.

5.8 Monthly recap = a Mixtape

What. Each month, auto-generate "Our " as a **playable** retrospective, not a stats dashboard: the month's shared songs + photo/diary highlights, as a mixtape you can press play on.

Why. Delight + retention; it makes the accumulated history feel alive and re-livable.

UX. On the 1st, a card appears: "Our September is ready." Opening shows a cover, the month's numbers (songs, photos, messages, moments), and a play button that runs the month's songs with the highlights as a backdrop. Saved to the timeline.

Data model. Mostly derived: a `monthly_recap(couple_id, month, generated_at, cover_ref)` plus queries over soundtrack / diary / sessions for that month.

Effort: M (generation job + a nice player screen).

5.9 "Our World" hub (the home)

What. The home screen of Harmony that ties all of the above together (see §4). Days together · today's question · **now-listening presence (hero)** · Soundtrack of Us · diary/memories · love capsule · tonight's moment (a 2-minute nightly ritual — same song + one line, great for distance).

Why. Gives the section a single, emotionally-anchored home instead of scattered features.

Effort: M — but best built **last**, once the pieces exist to surface.

5.10 Keepsake — bring a moment into Our Space (from any chat) — shipped

What. A per-message action that "keeps" a chat bubble — text, photo, **video**, voice note, song, or **GIF** — into the couple's **moments wall** in Our Space, where the two of them react to it privately. It is the bridge from the everyday chat surface into the memory garden (§3 / §5.1).

Why. Moments worth treasuring usually happen *in the flow of conversation*, often somewhere other than the partner's own DM — a friend's chat, a group. Keepsake lifts just that piece of content into the private space without a public "forward". It makes the chat surface feed Harmony, and it is squarely inside Aluta's moat (music included: a kept song also flows to the playlist / a dedication).

Composer (v1.5). The "Send a moment" composer pins any of **photo / video / voice note / file / song / note** (device pick → durable upload), and a "Dedicate a song instead" action opens the full dedication event — one sheet for everything that lands on the wall.

Where it lives — two entry points. 1. *The bubble quick-star.* A **subtle, ambient** affordance: a faint themed sparkle on a near-transparent circle, shown only on **real media** bubbles (photo / video / voice / song — **never** text, GIF or sticker, which stay clean and keep their press-and-hold menu). It rests hidden, eases in on a genuine tap, and dissolves on scroll or after a few idle seconds (desktop also reveals on hover). Never fights the reading experience. 2. *The overflow menu.* Keepsake also sits in the press-and-hold menu's Harmony group (pinned above the usual chat actions), alongside **Dedicate** and **Add to Our Playlist** on song bubbles. It is also **pinned** inside the full-screen photo and video viewers, so you can keep what you're immersed in without backing out.

Reach, not the chat's partner. The destination is the user's *own* bonded space — **not** whoever they are chatting with. So Keepsake is available from **any** conversation (a non-bonded friend's DM, a group) as long as the user holds at least one bond. One bond → keep straight there; several → a small **"Keep to…"** sheet (the current DM's partner space is pre-marked).

UX flow. Tap the star / menu → pick destination (if >1 bond) → for photo / video / voice / song, a small composer sheet shows a **preview** + an **optional one-line note** ("Add a note for you two…", with **emoji** input and tap-to-add **warmth chips**) and a **"Private to — only you two"** line → Keep. A plain-text bubble keeps in one tap. The moment lands on the wall with the author badge, the honest **type label** and icon, the content (photo auto-fit + zoomable; **video plays inline** in the card with expand-to-fullscreen; voice plays inline; song chip; GIF animates), the caption floating bold + centred over the bottom of media (plain text beneath for note/song/voice), and — like the shared diary — **multi-emoji reactions and a threaded comment conversation** (react with any emoji, toggle on/off with live counts; add, edit or delete comments; author badge + avatars reused from the diary). A **"Write about this in Our Diary"** gateway (v1.4) carries a moment into a fuller diary memory: the memory shows the moment's thumbnail at its top and taps back to the moment on the wall (`DiaryEntry.source_moment_id` + `source_thumb` , validated against the same bond).

Privacy (principle §2.7). No provenance is recorded — no "from a chat" tag, no originating person, and the **original chat caption is deliberately dropped**. Only the content + the keeper's optional note cross over.

Durability & access (principle §2.8). Kept media captures a **durable copy** from the device's local cache (re-uploaded non-ephemeral, moment-owned); a GIF keeps its external CDN url (already durable). The backend authorises **both bond members** to fetch a moment's asset (and dedicated / playlist assets by

pair membership), so a moment kept from a chat the partner was never in still loads for them, and never breaks after the source chat is purged.

Content → moment-kind mapping.

Bubble	Moment kind	Stored
text	`note`	text in `caption`
photo	`photo`	durable media ref; optional note in `caption`
video	`video`	durable media ref; optional note in `caption`
voice	`voice`	durable media ref; optional note in `caption`
song	`song`	`{title, ref}` JSON (durable ref); optional note in `caption`
GIF / sticker	`gif`	CDN url ref; optional note in `caption`

Data model. Reuses `pinned_moments` (`space_id` , `author_id` , `kind` , `ref` , `caption`). Moment kinds: `dedication, voice, photo, song, note, video, gif` . Moments are authored into the keeper's own space row and read across both partners' mirror rows (`pair_key` bond). **Reactions & comments (v1.3)** mirror the diary: `moment_reactions` is now keyed on `(moment_id, user_id, emoji)` — a `UniqueConstraint('_moment_react_emoji_uc')` replacing the old one-reaction-per-user constraint (dropped in-place by the schema migration), so each partner can hold several emoji at once — and a new `moment_comments(id, moment_id→pinned_moments, author_id, body, created_at, edited_at)` table carries the thread. A moment now serialises as `{ reactions:[{emoji,count}], my_reactions:[…], comment_count, comments:[…], mine }` .

Backend / realtime. Reuses `POST /spaces/{space_id}/moments` (space id from the user's own `GET /spaces`); a partner-resolving convenience pair also exists (`GET|POST /spaces/with/{partner_id}[/moments]`). Durable asset re-upload via the existing `/upload/media` ; `_asset_access` authorises space members (for `pinned_moments.ref`) and pair members (for `dedication.track_ref` , `playlist_tracks.ref`). **Reactions & comments (v1.3):** `react_moment` is a multi-emoji toggle returning the refreshed moment dict; new `GET|POST|PATCH|DELETE /{space_id}/moments/{moment_id}/comments` endpoints (guarded by a `_moment_for_member_or_404` check) reuse the diary's `_comment_dict` / `_DiaryCommentBody` . The client reuses the diary's top-level `diaryReactionRow` , `pickDiaryReaction` , `diaryAuthorBadge` and `resolveAvatarUrl` , plus a new `_MomentCommentsSheet` . Author's own open Our Space live-refreshes on keep/react (local `spaceEventBus` bump); the partner refreshes via the existing `space_moment` nudge and the new `space_moment_comment` WS event.

Edge cases. No bond → the Harmony group is hidden and the quick slot falls back to **Copy**. Deleted message → not keepable. Call / live / location / contact → kept as a friendly-label note, or skipped.

Effort: M (shipped) — reused the moments wall, playlist and dedication plumbing; the net-new work was durable-copy capture, the asset-access clause, video/gif kinds, inline video + auto-fit rendering, the ambient/pinned star UI, and (v1.3) bringing the diary's multi-emoji reactions + threaded comments to the moments wall.

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6. Technical architecture notes

The plan is deliberately built on what already exists, to keep it buildable:

- **Couple key.** A stable `couple_id` (sorted user-pair or the existing bond id). *Shipped as `pair_key` = sorted `"lo:hi"`; moments stay `space_id`-scoped but are read across both mirror rows of the bond.*
- **Realtime.** Reuse the existing WebSocket manager and the `now_playing_presence` / listen-together services. A single **simultaneous-reveal** pattern serves the daily question and mood sync; a **broadcast-in-session** pattern serves listen reactions; `space_moment` / `space_moment_comment` / `space_playlist_add` / `dedication_received` nudges live-refresh the open Our Space.
- **Storage.** Dedications/capsules reuse the chat voice-note recording + media upload; Soundtrack and recaps reuse the diary store and song-metadata helpers. Keepsake reuses the moments wall end to end (no new table).
- **Durable media (v1.2).** Chat is store-and-forward: `MediaAsset.data` bytes are nulled after delivery/cache-ack (ephemeral) or a 7-day TTL, images are exempt from the conversation purge, and `/attachments/<id>` is access-scoped to that chat's parties. Anything promoted out of a chat — Keepsake, **Forward**, Dedicate, Add-to-Playlist — therefore captures a durable copy (device cache → non-ephemeral re-upload) and is served to bond members via `_asset_access` clauses keyed by `pinned_moments.space_id` and by `pair_key` (dedications / playlist). Forwarded media is re-uploaded so the new recipient is an authorised party. Trade-off: durable copies persist in the DB rather than being swept — acceptable for treasured content; revisit with a tiered TTL if storage grows.
- **Video (v1.2).** Chat gained first-class video: an attach "Video" option, on-device compression for large clips (`video_compress`, mobile only; desktop/web fall back + a clear "too large" message), a per-type upload cap (video 64 MB vs 15 MB for images/files/voice), a `video` message type rendered as a poster bubble that opens a full-screen in-app player (`video_player`, with the Windows backend already present). The same player powers inline video in moment cards and the pinned-Keep full-screen surface.
- **Scheduling.** Capsule unlock + monthly recap need a server-side timer/cron.
- **Cosmetic rewards.** The streak's unlocks plug into the already-built `PlayerStyleController`.
- **Privacy.** Everything couple-scoped and private; reuse the per-friend audience gate. Content crossing *into* a space carries no provenance (§2.7) and is self-contained (§2.8).

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7. Phased roadmap

Phase 1 — The heartbeat (weeks 1–3). ✅ Shipped. The ritual loop that creates reasons to return. - Soundtrack of Us (§5.1) ✅ - Daily "Us" question + music variant (§5.2) ✅ - Dedications (§5.3) ✅ - *Added:* Keepsake — chat → Our Space bridge, now durable + video/GIF (§5.10) ✅ - *Enabling work:* chat video capability; durable-media architecture (§2.8, §6) ✅

Phase 2 — Depth & distance (weeks 4–6). - **Love Capsule + scheduled sync listen (§5.5)** — the next feature to build, and the next dashboard **tile** (fills the reserved 4th slot in the 2×2 grid). - Mood variant of the Daily "Us" question (§5.4 → folded into §5.2) — enriches an existing card; **no separate tile**. - Listen-together reactions + save session (§5.6)

Phase 3 — The world & the payoff (weeks 7–9). - "Our World" hub (§5.9) - "In tune" streak + disc-style unlocks (§5.7) - Monthly Mixtape recap (§5.8)

(Durations are indicative for a solo/small build and assume reuse of existing services.)

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8. Success metrics (relationship health, not vanity)

Measure whether the *relationship* is being served, not time-in-app:

- **Mutual-act days:** days where *both* partners did a meaningful act (the real signal).
- **Ritual completion:** % of daily questions both answered; dedications sent per week.
- **Soundtrack growth:** songs added per couple per month.
- **Moments kept:** keepsakes added per couple per month, and % that receive a partner reaction (two-way signal).
- **Distance value:** scheduled sync listens completed; capsules opened.
- **Returning-together rate:** couples active in Harmony 4+ weeks after pairing.

Explicitly **not** tracked as success: raw session length, notification open-rate, or any single "engagement" number that rewards compulsion.

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9. Risks & mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Feeling gimmicky / forced	Keep rituals optional and gentle; one nudge each; warm copy.
Streak guilt / manipulation	Streaks only on meaningful acts; grace day; never guilt nudges.
Asymmetry (one partner engages, one doesn't)	Design for the quiet partner — low-effort taps, dedications that invite without pressure.
Privacy anxiety	Couple-private by default; both opt-in; clear audience controls.
Kept content drags in a third person	No provenance on kept moments; original chat caption dropped; only content + keeper's note cross over (§2.7).
Kept media breaks after the chat is purged / partner can't view it	Capture a durable, moment-owned copy at keep time; authorise both bond members (§2.8, §6).
Large video can't be sent	On-device compression (mobile) + a raised 64 MB video cap; a clear message where compression isn't available.
Durable copies bloat the DB	Acceptable for treasured content now; revisit with a tiered/longer-but-not-forever TTL if storage grows.
Affordance noise (stars everywhere)	Media-only, ambient star that dissolves on idle/scroll; subtle faint-sparkle styling.
Scope creep	Ship Phase 1 and validate the ritual loop before Phase 2/3.

10. Open decisions (settle before coding)

1. **Couple key:** reuse an existing bond id, or derive a sorted user-pair id? — **Resolved:** `pair_key` = sorted `"lo:hi"`.
2. **One partner or many bonds?** — **Resolved:** a user may hold several bonds; cross-surface actions show a destination picker when there is more than one.
3. **Daily-question source:** curated static list vs. rotating sets vs. seasonal packs.
4. **Notifications:** confirm the "one gentle nudge per ritual" budget and quiet hours.
5. **Anniversary date:** where is "days together" seeded from (pairing date vs. a user-set anniversary)? — *Currently:* the space's `created_at` ("close since").
6. **Phase-1 cut:** confirm Soundtrack + Daily question + Dedications as the first shippable slice. — **Done** (plus Keepsake).
7. **Durable-media retention (v1.2):** keep durable copies forever, or move to a longer-but-bounded TTL once storage justifies it? — *Open.*
8. **Video quality/length caps (v1.2):** confirm the 64 MB cap and compression preset (currently MediumQuality); consider a max duration. — *Open.*

Next step: Phase 2 — Mood Sync, Love Capsule (scheduled sync listen), and richer listen-together — on your go-ahead, each turned into a concrete implementation plan (tables, API, Flutter screens, WS events) over the existing presence / listen-together services.